APEX COMPREHENSIVE HEALTH INSURANCE POLICY (PLAN GOLD-2026)

Policy ID: APH-2026-99410 | **Underwriter:** Apex Assurance Group LLC | **Effective Date:** January 1, 2026

SECTION 1: POLICY OVERVIEW & SCHEDULE OF BENEFITS

This Policy Agreement establishes comprehensive health insurance coverage provided by Apex Assurance Group to the Designated Policyholder and enrolled dependents. Coverage is subject to all deductibles, copayments, coinsurance rates, and exclusions outlined herein.

Benefit Category	In-Network Benefit	Out-of-Network Benefit
Individual Deductible	$1,500 per policy year	$3,000 per policy year
Family Deductible	$3,000 per policy year	$6,000 per policy year
Individual Out-of-Pocket Max	$5,000 per calendar year	$10,000 per calendar year
Family Out-of-Pocket Max	$10,000 per calendar year	$20,000 per calendar year
Primary Care Physician (PCP) Visit	$25 Copayment (deductible waived)	30% Coinsurance after deductible
Specialist Physician Visit	$50 Copayment (deductible waived)	40% Coinsurance after deductible
Annual Wellness / Preventive Exam	100% Covered (No Copayment)	Covered at 70% of allowed charges
Urgent Care Center	$45 Copayment per visit	30% Coinsurance after deductible

SECTION 2: DEFINITIONS AND KEY TERMS

2.1 Medically Necessary: Healthcare services or supplies that a licensed medical practitioner provides to evaluate, diagnose, or treat an illness, injury, disease, or its symptoms, meeting accepted medical standards.

2.2 Prior Authorization: Mandatory advance approval required from the insurer prior to receiving elective inpatient admissions, MRI/CT diagnostic imaging, and specialty infusion therapies.

2.3 Coinsurance: The percentage of covered medical expenses (e.g., 20%) that the Insured must pay after the annual deductible has been met.

SECTION 3: INPATIENT HOSPITALIZATION & SURGICAL BENEFITS

Hospital inpatient room and board is covered for semi-private accommodations up to a maximum duration of 180 consecutive days per benefit period. Private room accommodations are covered only if deemed medically imperative for patient isolation by attending physicians.

Inpatient Surgery Copay: Inpatient surgeries carry a $250 institutional copayment followed by 20% coinsurance in-network. Out-of-network inpatient hospitalizations are reimbursed at 50% of the Usual, Customary, and Reasonable (UCR) fee benchmark after meeting the out-of-network deductible.

Intensive Care Unit (ICU): ICU admissions are covered at 90% in-network after deductible, with zero daily dollar cap, provided prior notification is submitted within 24 hours of emergency admission.

SECTION 4: EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES

4.1 Emergency Room Visits: A $200 copayment applies per Emergency Room visit. The $200 copayment is completely waived if the Insured is formally admitted to the hospital within 24 hours of arrival.

4.2 Ground & Air Ambulance: Ground ambulance transportation is covered at 80% coinsurance after deductible up to $2,500 per incident. Air ambulance requires immediate threat to life or limb where ground transit exceeds 45 minutes, reimbursable at 90% up to $25,000 per incident.

4.3 Non-Emergency ER Penalty: If an Emergency Room visit is diagnosed as non-emergent (e.g. routine prescription refill or minor cold symptoms), an administrative non-emergency surcharge of $150 may be assessed.

SECTION 5: PRESCRIPTION DRUG FORMULARY & PHARMACY BENEFITS

Prescription benefits are categorized across four formulary tiers. Maintenance medications may be ordered in 90-day supplies through Apex Mail-Order Pharmacy at a discounted copay rate (2.5x the 30-day retail copayment).

Formulary Tier	30-Day Retail Copay	90-Day Mail Order Copay	Notes / Prior Auth
Tier 1: Generic	$10 Copay	$25 Copay	No prior authorization required
Tier 2: Preferred Brand	$35 Copay	$87.50 Copay	Step therapy may apply
Tier 3: Non-Preferred Brand	$70 Copay	$175 Copay	Requires clinical justification
Tier 4: Specialty Biologics	25% Coinsurance (Max $250)	Not available by mail	Strict prior authorization required

SECTION 6: BEHAVIORAL HEALTH & SUBSTANCE ABUSE TREATMENT

6.1 Outpatient Mental Health: Outpatient psychotherapy, psychiatric evaluation, and behavioral counseling sessions carry a $25 copayment per session with no annual limit on outpatient visits, in strict compliance with the Mental Health Parity and Addiction Equity Act.

6.2 Inpatient Detoxification and Rehabilitation: Inpatient substance abuse detoxification is covered for up to 30 days per calendar year. Residential rehabilitation requires pre-certification from the Apex Behavioral Health Management division.

SECTION 7: PRE-EXISTING CONDITIONS & WAITING PERIODS

7.1 Definition: A pre-existing condition is any physical or mental injury, illness, or medical state for which medical advice, diagnosis, care, or treatment was recommended or received during the 6 months prior to the effective date of this policy.

7.2 Waiting Period Schedule:

• Standard Pre-Existing Condition Waiting Period: **12 consecutive months** from the effective date of coverage. Claims arising directly from disclosed pre-existing conditions are excluded during this period.

• Waiver of Waiting Period: The 12-month waiting period shall be waived in full if the Insured presents proof of continuous prior creditable coverage for at least 12 months with no break in coverage exceeding 63 days.

• Exceptions: Pre-existing condition waiting periods do NOT apply to pregnancy, childbirth, newborn adoption, or to enrolled individuals under the age of 19.

SECTION 8: MATERNITY, NEWBORN, AND REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH

8.1 Maternity Care: Routine prenatal visits are covered at 100% with no copayment. Labor, delivery, and post-partum inpatient hospital care are covered under standard inpatient hospitalization benefits ($250 copay + 20% coinsurance).

8.2 Newborn Coverage: A newborn child is automatically covered for the first 31 days following birth. The policyholder must submit an enrollment amendment within 31 days to maintain continuous dependent coverage.

8.3 Infertility Treatment: In vitro fertilization (IVF) and artificial insemination are subject to a lifetime maximum benefit of $15,000 per insured individual.

SECTION 9: GENERAL EXCLUSIONS AND NON-COVERED SERVICES

The following procedures, treatments, and expenses are strictly excluded from coverage under this policy:

9.1 Cosmetic Surgery: Elective aesthetic or cosmetic surgeries performed solely for appearance enhancement, including rhinoplasty, liposuction, and breast augmentation without reconstructive oncology necessity.

9.2 Experimental or Investigational Treatments: Any drugs, devices, medical therapies, or clinical trial procedures not officially approved by the FDA for the diagnosed indication.

9.3 Alternative Medicine: Acupuncture, homeopathic remedies, naturopathic consultation, and ayurvedic therapies (unless an optional Integrative Medicine Rider has been explicitly purchased).

9.4 Adult Dental and Routine Vision: Routine adult dental examinations, cleanings, orthodontia, eyeglasses, and laser vision correction (LASIK) are not covered under this health plan. Separate Dental and Vision riders are required.

9.5 Work-Related Injuries: Injuries sustained in the course of employment that are compensable under Workers' Compensation statutes or employer liability legislation.

SECTION 10: CLAIMS PROCEDURES, TIMELINES, AND APPEALS

10.1 Timely Filing Deadline: All claims for reimbursement must be submitted within **180 calendar days** from the date services were rendered. Out-of-network claims submitted after 180 days are subject to administrative denial.

10.2 Claim Adjudication Timeline: Apex Assurance will adjudicate clean, complete electronic claims within **30 business days** of receipt. Incomplete claims will receive a Request for Additional Information within 15 days.

10.3 Grievance and Appeals Process:

• Level 1 Internal Appeal: The Insured has 180 days from the date of an adverse benefit determination to file a Level 1 appeal. Decisions are rendered within 30 calendar days for standard claims and 72 hours for urgent medical care.

• Level 2 External Review: If the Level 1 appeal is upheld, the Insured may request an Independent Review Organization (IRO) external review within 4 months of the final internal denial.

Customer Support & Claims Submission:
Apex Claims Center, PO Box 9021, Hartford, CT 06101
Phone: 1-800-555-APEX | Portal: https://apex-insurance-claims.internal/submit